

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent Application Publication

20250268389

Kind Code

A1

Publication Date

August 28, 2025

Inventor(s)

Peterson; Bruce W. et al.

POCKETED SPRING ASSEMBLY INCLUDING CUSHION PADS AND BUCKLING MEMBERS WITH ADDITIVES

Abstract

A pocketed spring assembly comprises a plurality of parallel strings of springs, each string joined to at least one adjacent string, each string comprising one piece of fabric folded into first and second opposed plies. Outer pockets are formed along each string by transverse seams joining the first and second plies. One pocketed spring, at least cushion pad and at least one buckling member with an additive are positioned in each outer pocket. At least one cushion pad, at least one buckling member with an additive or any combination thereof may be individually pocketed inside an outer pocket.

Inventors: Peterson; Bruce W. (Austin, TX), McKnight; Matthew D. (Fort Smith, AR), Hironaka; Takayuki (Fort Smith, AR)

Applicant: L&P Property Management Company (South Gate, CA)

Family ID: 1000007714847

Assignee: Leggett & Platt Property Management Company (South Gate, CA)

Appl. No.: 18/586656

Filed: February 26, 2024

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: A47C27/06 (20060101); A47C27/07 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC A47C27/064 (20130101); A47C27/07 (20130101);

Background/Summary

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

[0001] This invention relates generally to bedding and seating products and, more particularly, to pocketed spring assemblies used in bedding and seating products.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

[0002] Mattress spring core construction over the years has been a continuously improving art with advancements in materials and machine technology. A well-known form of spring core construction is known as a Marshall spring construction wherein metal coil springs are encapsulated in individual pockets of fabric and formed as elongate or continuous strings of pocketed coil springs. In an earlier form, these strings of coil springs were manufactured by folding an elongate piece of fabric in half lengthwise to form two plies of fabric and stitching transverse and longitudinal seams to join the plies of fabric to define pockets within which the springs were enveloped.

[0003] Improvements in spring core constructions have involved the use of fabrics which are thermally or ultrasonically weldable to themselves. By using such welding techniques, these fabrics have been advantageously used to create strings of individually pocketed coil springs wherein transverse and longitudinal welds, instead of stitching, are used to form the pockets encapsulating the springs.

[0004] Once strings of pocketed springs are constructed, they may be assembled to form a pocketed spring core or assembly for a mattress, cushion or the like by a variety of methods. For example, multiple or continuous strings may be arranged in a row pattern corresponding to the desired size and shape of a mattress or the like, and adjacent rows of strings may be interconnected by a variety of methods. The result is a unitary assembly of pocketed coil springs serving as a complete spring core assembly.

[0005] Conventional pocketed spring cores incorporating pocketed strings of springs have less motion transfer between sleeping partners when compared to traditional helically-laced open coil spring assemblies. Each pocketed coil spring is able to move with greater independence and, therefore provide less influence on adjacent pocketed coil springs than if the coil springs were not inside individual pockets. However, with a traditional pocketed spring mattress, a sheet of foam or other cushioning layer is attached to an upper surface of the pocketed spring assembly. The foam or cushioning sheet or sheets acts like a bridge, such that a load applied to one side of a mattress affects the other side of the mattress, providing an undesirable bridging effect. The present invention eliminates the undesirable bridging effect by encapsulating individual cushion members inside outer pockets of strings of springs.

[0006] U.S. Pat. No. 6,490,744 discloses a pocketed spring assembly incorporating strings which have individually pocketed coil springs with cushioning pads inside the pockets. However, due to the individual coil springs being un-pocketed, the coil springs may damage the cushioning pads and/or affect the feel of the pocketed spring assembly due to the coil springs pressing against the cushioning pads. The capability of the individually pocketed springs to act independently from the adjacent pocketed springs in the string of springs may be compromised.

[0007] Therefore, there remains a need to combine multiple technologies to improve the feel and motion transfer in a bedding or seating product having a pocketed spring core.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0008] In one aspect, a bedding or seating product is provided. The product comprises a pocketed spring assembly comprising a plurality of parallel strings of springs, each string joined to at least one adjacent string. Each string comprises a piece of fabric surrounding a plurality of inner pocketed springs, a plurality of cushion pads and a plurality of buckling members, first and second opposed plies of fabric being on opposite sides of the pocketed springs, cushion pads and buckling members. Outer pockets are formed along the length of the string by a longitudinal seam and transverse seams joining the first and second plies. At least one pocketed spring, at least one cushion pad and at least one buckling member are in each of the outer pockets. Each cushion pad

may be individually pocketed and may be any desired size or shape. Each buckling member may be individually pocketed and may be any desired size or shape. At least one cushion pad and at least one buckling member may be pocketed together and may be any desired size or shape.

[0009] At least some of the buckling members contains at least one of the following additives: phase change materials, plant-based fibers, synthetic fibers, fragrances, slow-release fragrances, organic and inorganic antimicrobial additives, color additives, thermochromic materials, conductive additive solids, powders, particles, flakes, density reducing agents or gas generating materials.

[0010] Different coil springs may be located inside the inner pockets. In one embodiment, each of the coil springs has upper and lower end turns and a plurality of central convolutions between the end turns, the convolutions decreasing in diameter and pitch from a middle portion of the spring towards at least one of the end turns. In another embodiment, each of the coil springs has upper and lower end turns and a plurality of central convolutions between the end turns, each of the convolutions being the same diameter. Regardless of the configuration of coil spring, each coil spring is preferably made of one piece of wire of a uniform diameter, but not in all cases.

[0011] In some embodiments, an upper end of each transverse seam forming adjacent pockets of the string is below an upper surface of the string of springs to partially separate adjacent outer pockets. In other embodiments, such as double-sided pocketed spring assemblies, each end of each transverse seams has a length less than the height of the of the string to partially separate adjacent outer pockets. In the bedding industry, pocketed spring assemblies having such transverse seams are said to have a “split top” feature. Cushioning materials may be placed on the pocketed spring assembly, and a covering, usually an upholstered covering, encases the pocketed spring assembly and cushioning materials.

[0012] The strings may extend longitudinally (from end-to-end) or transversely (from side-to-side). A pocketed spring assembly for use in a bedding or seating product may be posturized into regions or zones of different firmness by incorporating different strings into the pocketed spring assembly.

[0013] If the strings extend transversely, the pocketed spring assembly may include a plurality of the strings having the “split top” feature in the transverse seams between adjacent outer pockets and strings lacking the “split top” feature, the strings arranged in a plurality of zones longitudinally spaced apart. For example, the pocketed spring assembly may include three such zones. The three zones may comprise a central zone, a head end zone and a foot end zone. The end zones may comprise strings having the “split top” feature, and the strings comprising central zone may comprise strings lacking the “split top” feature. Alternatively, the end zones may comprise strings lacking the “split top” feature, and the strings comprising central zone may comprise strings with the “split top” feature.

[0014] If the strings extend longitudinally, the pocketed spring assembly may include strings having the “split top” feature in the transverse seams between adjacent outer pockets and other strings lacking the “split top” feature, the strings arranged in a plurality of zones transversely spaced apart. For example, the pocketed spring assembly may include two such zones, a “his” side and a “hers” side. The “hers” side or zone may comprise strings of springs having the “split top” feature, and the “his” side or zone can comprise strings of springs lacking the “split top” feature.

[0015] In another aspect, a pocketed spring assembly for a bedding or seating product is provided. The pocketed spring assembly comprises a plurality of parallel strings. Each string is joined to at least one adjacent string. Each of the strings comprises a plurality of interconnected outer pockets made from one piece of fabric. Each of the outer pockets contains at least one inner pocketed spring, at least one cushion pad and at least one buckling member. The piece of fabric is joined to itself along a longitudinal seam and has first and second opposed plies of fabric on opposite sides of the inner pocketed springs. The first and second plies of fabric are joined by transverse seams between adjacent inner pocketed springs.

[0016] In some embodiments, each of the transverse seams forming the adjacent outer pockets of

the string has one end located below an upper surface of the string to partially separate adjacent outer pockets. In other embodiments, each of the transverse seams forming the adjacent outer pockets of the string has one end located below an upper surface of the string and the other end located above a lower surface of the string. Such a string is considered to have the “split top” feature on both sides of the string.

[0017] In another aspect, a string of springs for a pocketed spring assembly for a bedding or seating product is provided. The pocketed spring assembly comprises a plurality of parallel strings of springs. Each string is joined to an adjacent string. Each of the strings comprises a plurality of interconnected outer pockets made from one piece of fabric. Each of the outer pockets contains at least one inner pocketed spring, at least one cushion pad and at least one buckling member. The piece of fabric is joined to itself along a longitudinal seam and has first and second opposed plies of fabric on opposite sides of the inner pocketed springs. The fabric of the first and second plies is joined by transverse seams which are shorter than the string. Each of the transverse seams forming the adjacent outer pockets of the string has an upper end located below an upper surface of the string to partially separate adjacent outer pockets and enable some of the buckling members to compress without substantially compressing the buckling members within other outer pockets of the spring.

[0018] One advantage of the present invention is that when a bedding or seating product, such as a mattress, is manufactured, the manufacturer need not place one or more sheets of cushioning material over the pocketed spring assembly prior to the unit being upholstered. The mattress manufacturer may simply place a cover around the pocketed spring assembly without using any sheets of cushioning material.

[0019] Another advantage of the present invention is that the inner pocketed coil spring does not press into the cushion pad above/below it when subjected to a load. Because the inner pocketed spring is retained in its own inner pocket independent of the cushion pad or pads, the inner pocketed spring does not exert force on the cushion pad or pads, thereby preserving the designed characteristics of the cushion pad or pads such as firmness, for example. The inner pockets of fabric surrounding the coil springs and/or the fabric surrounding each cushion pad preserves the integrity of the cushion pads and increases the life of the pocketed spring assembly. The result is that the user “feels” more of the cushion pad or pads.

[0020] The accompanying drawings, which are incorporated in and constitute a part of this specification, illustrate embodiments of the invention and, together with the summary of the invention given above, and the detailed description of the drawings given below, serve to explain the principles of the present invention.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0021] FIG. 1 is a perspective view, partially broken away, of a bedding or seating product incorporating a pocketed spring assembly according to the principles of the present invention.

[0022] FIG. 1A is a perspective view, partially broken away, of a bedding or seating product incorporating another pocketed spring assembly.

[0023] FIG. 1B is a perspective view, partially broken away, of a double-sided bedding product incorporating another pocketed spring assembly.

[0024] FIG. 1C is a perspective view, partially broken away, of another bedding product incorporating the pocketed spring assembly of FIG. 1.

[0025] FIG. 2 is a perspective view, partially broken away, of a portion of a string of springs of the pocketed spring assembly of FIG. 1 in an unloaded condition.

[0026] FIG. 2A is a perspective view, partially broken away, of a portion of another string of

springs in an unloaded condition.

[0027] FIG. 2B is a perspective view of a buckling member with additives in a relaxed condition.

[0028] FIG. 3 is a cross-sectional view, partially broken away, of the portion of the string of FIG. 2 in an unloaded condition.

[0029] FIG. 3A is a cross-sectional view, partially broken away, of a portion of an alternative string in an unloaded condition.

[0030] FIG. 3B is a cross-sectional view, partially broken away, of the portion of the string of FIG. 3A showing two pocketed springs being in a loaded condition.

[0031] FIG. 3C is a cross-sectional view, partially broken away, of a string of springs having a different spring in an unloaded condition.

[0032] FIG. 3D is a cross-sectional view, partially broken away, of a string of springs having a different spring in an unloaded condition.

[0033] FIG. 4 is a perspective view of a portion of the pocketed spring assembly of FIG. 1 in a relaxed condition.

[0034] FIG. 5 is a perspective view of a portion of another pocketed spring assembly in a relaxed condition, the strings of springs being offset from one another.

[0035] FIG. 6 is a cross-sectional view, partially broken away, of another string of springs in an unloaded condition.

[0036] FIG. 6A is a cross-sectional view, partially broken away, of another string of springs in an unloaded condition.

[0037] FIG. 7 is a cross-sectional view, partially broken away, of double-sided string of springs in an unloaded condition.

[0038] FIG. 8 is a top view of a posturized pocketed spring assembly.

[0039] FIG. 9 is a top view of another posturized pocketed spring assembly.

[0040] FIG. 10 is a cross-sectional view, partially broken away, of another string of springs in an unloaded condition.

[0041] FIG. 11 is a cross-sectional view, partially broken away, of another string of springs in an unloaded condition.

[0042] FIG. 12A is a top view of an alternative buckling member.

[0043] FIG. 12B is a top view of an alternative buckling member.

[0044] FIG. 12C is a top view of an alternative buckling member.

[0045] FIG. 12D is a top view of an alternative buckling member.

[0046] FIG. 12E is a top view of an alternative buckling member.

[0047] FIG. 12F is a top view of an alternative buckling member.

[0048] FIG. 12G is a top view of an alternative buckling member.

[0049] FIG. 12H is a top view of an alternative buckling member.

[0050] FIG. 13 is a schematic cross-sectional view of one string of springs in an unloaded condition.

[0051] FIG. 14 is a schematic cross-sectional view of another string of springs in an unloaded condition.

[0052] FIG. 15 is a schematic cross-sectional view of another string of springs in an unloaded condition.

[0053] FIG. 16 is a schematic cross-sectional view of another string of springs in an unloaded condition.

[0054] FIG. 17 is a schematic cross-sectional view of another string of springs in an unloaded condition.

[0055] FIG. 18 is a schematic cross-sectional view of another string of springs in an unloaded condition.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

[0056] Referring first to FIG. 1, there is illustrated a bedding product in the form of a single-sided

mattress **10** incorporating the principles of the present invention. This product or mattress **10** comprises a pocketed spring assembly **12** over the top of which there lay conventional padding or cushioning layers **14**, **16** which may be foam, fiber, gel, a pocketed spring blanket or any other suitable materials or any combination thereof. The pocketed spring assembly **12** includes a central portion **15** and border **17** surrounding the central portion **15**. The pocketed coil springs **11** of the border **17** may be of a different diameter than pocketed coil springs **28** of the central portion **15**. Although one type of border **17** is illustrated, the border may assume other forms or shapes of any desired size, such as pocketed coil springs of different geometries than the pocketed springs of the central portion. Alternatively, the border **17** may be omitted in this embodiment or any embodiment described or shown herein. This complete assembly is mounted upon a base **18** and is completely enclosed within an upholstered covering material **20**.

[0057] As shown in FIG. **1**, fully assembled, the product **10** has a length “L” defined as the linear distance between opposed end surfaces **22** (only one being shown in FIG. **1**). Similarly, the assembled product **10** has a width “W” defined as the linear distance between opposed side surfaces **24** (only one being shown in FIG. **1**). In the product shown in FIG. **1**, the length is illustrated as being greater than the width. However, it is within the scope of the present invention that the length and width may be identical, as in a square product.

[0058] As shown in FIG. **1**, the central portion **15** of pocketed spring assembly **12** is manufactured from multiple strings **26** of pocketed springs **28** joined together. Each string of pocketed springs **26** extends longitudinally or from head-to-foot along the full length of the product **10**.

[0059] Although the central portion **15** of the strings of pocketed springs **26** are illustrated as extending longitudinally or from head-to-foot in the pocketed spring assembly **12** of FIG. **1**, they may extend transversely or from side-to-side as shown in the pocketed spring assembly **12a** shown in the product **10a** shown in FIG. **1A**. The central portion **15** of pocketed spring assembly **12a** comprises multiple strings **26a** of pocketed springs, identical to the strings of springs **26**, but shorter in length.

[0060] FIG. **1B** illustrates a double-sided mattress **10b** comprising a pocketed spring assembly **12b** having a central portion **15** and border **17**, as shown in the mattress **10** of FIG. **1**. However, the mattress **10b** of FIG. **1B** has conventional padding layers **14**, **16** above and below a double-sided pocketed spring assembly **12b**. The central portion **15** of the double-sided pocketed spring assembly **12b** comprises a plurality of strings **26b** of pocketed springs, one being partially shown in cross-section in FIG. **7**.

[0061] FIG. **1C** illustrates a single-sided mattress **10c** comprising a pocketed spring assembly **12** having a central portion **15** and border **17**, as shown in the mattress **10** of FIG. **1**. However, the mattress **10c** of FIG. **1C** has a pocketed topper **19** comprising miniature pocketed coil springs in addition to padding layers **14**, **16** above the pocketed topper **19**. A scrim layer **21** separates the pocketed topper **19** from the pocketed spring assembly **12**. Although one configuration of pocketed topper **19** is illustrated, any pocketed topper or comfort layer known in the art may be used.

[0062] According to this invention, any of the padding or cushioning layers, including the pocketed topper **19**, may be omitted in any of the embodiments shown or described herein. The novel features reside in the pocketed spring assembly, in at least one of the central portion or border of the pocketed spring assembly.

[0063] These strings of pocketed springs **26**, **26a** and **26b**, and any other strings of springs described or shown herein, may be connected in side-by-side relationship as, for example, by gluing the sides of the strings together in an assembly machine, to create an assembly or matrix of springs having multiple rows and columns of pocketed springs bound together as by gluing, welding or any other conventional assembly process commonly used to create pocketed spring cores or assemblies.

[0064] Referring to FIGS. **4** and **5**, the strings **26** of pocketed springs may be joined so that the individually pocketed springs **28** are aligned in transversely extending rows **30** and longitudinally

extending columns 32. Alternatively, the strings 26 of pocketed springs may be offset from one another in a pocketed spring assembly. In such an arrangement, shown in FIG. 5, the individually pocketed springs 28 are not aligned in rows and columns; instead the individually pocketed springs 28 fill gaps or voids 70 of the adjacent strings 26. FIG. 5 shows a portion of a pocketed spring assembly 12' with multiple strings 26 arranged in this manner. Either alignment of strings may be incorporated into any of the pocketed spring assemblies or cores illustrated or described herein. Although FIGS. 4 and 5 illustrate strings 26, the same alignments may be used in any pocketed spring assembly disclosed herein having any strings disclosed herein including strings 26a or 26b. [0065] As best illustrated in FIGS. 2, 3A and 3B, each string 26 of pocketed springs 28 comprises a row of interconnected fabric outer pockets 34. Each of the fabric outer pockets 34 contains at least one inner pocketed coil spring 82, at least one cushion pad 54 and at least one buckling member 55. Each inner pocketed coil spring 82 comprises a coil spring 36 encased in an inner pocket 35 having two side seams 37. The inner pocket 35 may be made of a single piece of fabric or any number of pieces of fabric.

[0066] FIGS. 2, 3A and 3B illustrate a one-sided string 26 for use in a single-sided pocketed spring assembly, such as pocketed spring assembly 12. In string 26, one cushion pad 54 rests on the fabric of the inner pocket 35 above the individually pocketed coil spring 36. In this orientation, the coil spring 36 is prevented from contacting and damaging the material of the cushion pad 54.

[0067] In string 26, one cylindrical shaped buckling member 55 rests on the cushion pad 54 above the cushion pad 54. In the drawings the buckling member 55 is illustrated having approximately the same height as the cushion pad 54. However, the buckling member 55 may have a different height than the cushion pad 54.

[0068] For ease of understanding, FIG. 2 illustrates the leftmost outer pocket 34 shown in dashed lines and the inner pocket 35 shown in solid lines. In FIG. 2, the other outer pockets 34 of string 26 are shown in solid lines and the inner pockets 35 shown in dashed lines.

[0069] As best shown in FIG. 2, the cushion pad 54 is shown as being shaped like a hockey puck or puck-shaped. Cushion pad 54 is illustrated having a circular upper surface 76, a circular lower surface 78 and a sidewall 80.

[0070] As best shown in FIGS. 2, 2A and 2B, the buckling member 55 is shown as being cylindrically shaped like a hockey puck or puck-shaped too. Buckling member 55 is illustrated having an outer wall 57 having an outer surface 59 and an inner surface 61, the distance between which defines the thickness "T" of the outer wall 57. The buckling member 55 has three internal ribs 63 which extend from the outer wall 57 to a center 65. The buckling member 55 has a generally planar upper surface 67 and a generally planar lower surface 69 which define the height "HH" of the buckling member 55. The buckling member 55 has an open top 71 and open bottom 73 defining three passages 75 between the internal ribs 63. Although the drawings illustrate one thickness "T" of outer wall 57, the outer wall may be any desired thickness. Although the drawings illustrate the internal ribs 63 having one thickness, the internal ribs may be any desired thickness.

[0071] FIG. 2A illustrates a string 27 identical to string 26 but having a different cushion pad 54a. Cushion pad 54a has a different shape than cushion pads 54 inside the inner pockets 35 of the string 27. FIG. 2A illustrates a cushion pad 54a having a rectangular upper surface 76a, a rectangular lower surface 78a and four rectangular sidewalls 80a. Although FIG. 2A illustrates square upper and lower surfaces and sidewalls, one or more surfaces or sidewalls may be other rectangular shapes. Although FIGS. 2 and 2A illustrate cushion pads 54, 54a, respectively, and buckling members 55 of a certain size and shape, the drawings are not intended to limit the size or shape of the cushion pads or buckling members.

[0072] Each cushion pad 54, 54a is illustrated being a single piece of material, such as foam, but may be any number of pieces of any desired material joined together. Alternatively, the cushion pad 54, 54a may be made of fiber, cotton, gel or any combination thereof.

[0073] In any embodiment shown or described herein, the buckling member can be made of

silicone, a gel elastomer, polyurethane elastomer, polyurea elastomer, polyester, polystyrene, polyethylene, polypropylene and blends thereof. Any other suitable material which buckles when a large enough load is applied thereto may be used such as rubber, latex or other plastic material. Any of the elastomers may be fiber reinforced.

[0074] The buckling column may be made of acrylic rubber, acrylonitrile butadiene rubber, butyl rubber, EPDM, EVM, halogenated nitrile rubber, isoprene rubber, natural rubber, neoprene, polythioethers, silicone rubber, styrene-butadiene, styrene copolymers, polystyrene, thermoplastic elastomers, vinyl methyl silicone, silicone, gel elastomer (SEBS, SEEPS, etc.), polyurethane elastomer, polyurea elastomer, polyester, polyethylene, polypropylene and blends thereof.

[0075] Regardless of the material used to make any of the buckling members shown or described herein, including buckling member **55**, additives such as phase change materials, plant-based fibers such as cellulose, cotton, hemp, linen, jute, wool and the like, synthetic fibers including carbon fiber, nylon, olefin, acrylic, polyester, rayon, vinyon, spandex, vinalon, aramids, Modal, PBI, Orlon and the like, fragrances including slow-release fragrances, organic and inorganic antimicrobial additives such as zinc omadine, N-Butyl-1,2-Benzisothiazolin-3-one, OIT (2-n-Octyl-4-isothiazolin-3-one, 3-(Trimethoxy)silyl) propyldimethyloctadecyl ammonium chloride, copper and silver and the like, color additives, thermochromic materials, conductive additive solids, powders, particles, flakes such as activated carbon, carbon nanotubes, graphene, graphite, aluminum powder, silicon carbide, diamond dust and the like may be incorporated into the material. Density reducing agents such as fumed silica or gas generating materials may be added too. FIG. 2A illustrates additives **81** incorporated into the material of the buckling member **55**.

[0076] The coil spring **36** is preferably made of one piece of wire of a uniform diameter, but may be made of other materials, multiple strands of twisted wire and/or may be a non-uniform diameter. As best shown in FIG. 2, each coil spring **36** has a central or longitudinal axis A, an upper end turn **38**, a lower end turn **40** and a plurality of central convolutions **42** between the end turns. FIGS. 2 and 3A illustrate a barrel-shaped coil spring **36** in which the diameter of the end turns **38**, **40** is less than the diameter of the central convolutions **42**, the central convolutions **42** tapering or decreasing in diameter and pitch as one moves from a center or middle portion **44** of the coil spring towards the end turns. As best shown in FIG. 2, each barrel-shaped coil spring **36** has two end portions which are not identical, an upper end portion **46** and a lower end portion **48**.

[0077] Preferably, one piece of fabric is used to create the outer pockets **34** of the string **26** of pocketed springs **36**, the piece of fabric being folded over onto itself around the inner pocketed coil springs **82** and the cushion pads **54**. As best shown in FIG. 2, opposite sides or plies **47**, **49** of the fabric are sewn, welded or otherwise secured together to create a longitudinal seam **50** and a plurality of separating or transverse seams **52**. FIG. 2 illustrates ply **47** being closest to the reader and ply **49** being behind the springs **36**.

[0078] Although the seams or welds in the embodiments shown herein are shown as being welded spaced rectangles, any of the seams may be spaced dots, triangles or solid line segments without spaces.

[0079] As best shown in FIG. 2, opposed edges **56** of the piece of fabric used to create the string **26** of pocketed springs are aligned and spaced from the longitudinal seam **50** a distance indicated by numeral **58**. Although the drawings indicated the longitudinal seam **50** being below the free edges **56** of the piece of fabric, the longitudinal seam **50** may be above the free edges **56** of the piece of fabric.

[0080] As shown in FIGS. 2 and 3, the piece of fabric used to create the string **26** has a plurality of upper ears **53** and a plurality of lower ears **83**. When the ears are collapsed, the string **26** has a generally planar top surface **60** in a top plane P1 and a parallel generally planar bottom surface **62** in a bottom plane P2. The linear distance between the top and bottom surfaces **60**, **62** of the string **26** defines a height “H” of the string **26**. This linear distance further defines the height H of the pocketed spring assembly **12** because each of the strings **26** has the same height. However, it is

within the scope of the present invention that different strings of springs of a pocketed spring assembly have different heights.

[0081] As shown in FIGS. 2 and 3, in one embodiment, the transverse seams 52 of string 26 separating adjacent pockets extend from the top of an upper ear 53 of fabric to the bottom of a lower ear 83 of fabric. In an alternative embodiment shown in FIGS. 3A and 3B, the transverse seams 152 of string 126 separating adjacent pockets extend short of the upper and lower ears 53, 83 of fabric, respectively. In the alternative embodiment shown in FIGS. 3A and 3B, each transverse seam 152 is shorter than the height of the string 126 due to divides 64 described herein.

[0082] In accordance with the alternative embodiment shown in FIGS. 3A and 3B, in strings 126, the transverse seams 152 separating adjacent outer pockets 34 are divided with divides 64 which may be in the form cuts, slits, or notches created by, for example, cutting, slitting, severing, melting, or the like, from the upper surface 60 of the string 126 inwardly (downwardly as illustrated), to partially separate the adjacent outer pockets 34. Preferably, the divide 64 extends to beyond or below the buckling member 55 but may be any desired length including less than the height of the buckling member 55. As best shown in FIGS. 3A and 3B, the transverse seams 152 of the strings 126 each have an upper end 66 located at the bottom of each divide 64 and a lower end (not shown). As shown in FIG. 3A, the upper end 66 of each transverse seam 152 is located below adjacent buckling member 55 when the inner pocketed coil springs 36 are in a relaxed condition and not loaded. Like the string 26b shown in FIG. 7, in a double-sided pocketed spring assembly, the lower end of each transverse seam 152 of the strings 126 may have a divide 64 extending upwardly from a lower surface 62 of the string 126.

[0083] The significance of divide 64 may be appreciated with reference to FIG. 3B. Divide 64 essentially decouples each buckling member 55 from its adjacent buckling member 55 during initial deflection of buckling member 55. This creates more of an individual coil performance and allows the inner pocketed coil spring 82 to engage a person sleeping on the mattress 10 sooner while giving the person a softer feel at the beginning of the coil deflections. It is believed that this arrangement provides a more comfortable pocketed spring assembly 12.

[0084] FIG. 6 illustrates another embodiment of string 26c which may be used in any of the pocketed spring assemblies or products shown or described herein. The string 26c comprises the same seams, same inner pocketed springs 82 and outer fabric pockets 34 as incorporated into strings 26. However, each of the outer fabric pockets 34 includes a combination pad 51 above the inner pocketed coil spring 82. The combination pad 51 comprises a cushion pad 54 and a buckling member 55 which in combination are encased in a fabric cover 84. Each combination pad 51 has its own fabric cover 84 which prevents the coil spring 36 of the inner pocketed coil spring 82 from contacting and damaging the cushion pad or pads over time, in addition to the inner pocket 35 of fabric of the inner pocketed coil spring 82. Although FIG. 6 illustrates each combination pad 51 comprising one cushion pad 54 and one buckling member 55 encased in a fabric cover 84, a combination pad may include more than one cushion pad and/or more than one buckling member. It is also within the scope of the invention that the combination pad 51 comprises one buckling member 55 and one cushion pad 54 encased in a fabric cover 84, the buckling member 55 being closer to the inner pocketed coil spring 82.

[0085] FIG. 6A illustrates another embodiment of string 26cc which may be used in any of the pocketed spring assemblies or products shown or described herein. The string 26cc comprises the same seams, same inner pocketed springs 82 and outer fabric pockets 34 as incorporated into strings 26. However, each cushion pad 54 is encased in a fabric cover 84b and each buckling member 55 is encased in a fabric cover 84a. Thus, each cushion pad 54 has its own fabric cover 84b which prevents the coil spring 36 of the inner pocketed coil spring 82 from contacting and damaging the cushion pad or pads over time, in addition to the inner pocket 35 of fabric of the inner pocketed coil spring 82.

[0086] FIG. 7 illustrates another embodiment of string 26b which may be used in any of the

double-sided pocketed spring assemblies such as double-sided pocketed spring assembly **12b** used in double-sided mattress **10b** shown in FIG. **1B**. Although string **26b** shown in FIG. **7** is shown having the split top feature like the strings **126** shown in FIG. **3A**, any strings shown or disclosed herein may lack the split top feature regarding of whether single-sided or double-sided. Any of the strings shown herein may be incorporated into any bedding or seating product, including any double-sided mattress or seating cushion. For example, while the mattresses **10**, **10a** and **10c** illustrated in FIGS. **1**, **1A** and **1C**, respectively, are single-sided mattresses having single-sided pocketed spring assemblies **12**, **12a** and **12c**, respectively, incorporating single-sided strings, any of the strings shown or described herein as being single-sided, may be double-sided for use in a double-sided mattress or seating cushion. Likewise, any of the strings shown or described herein as being double-sided, may be single-sided for use in a single-sided mattress or seating cushion.

[0087] FIG. **7** illustrates a portion of a string of springs **26b** used in a double-sided pocketed spring assembly, like pocketed spring assembly **12b** shown in FIG. **1B**. The fabric outer pockets **34b** of such strings **26b** are slightly different than the fabric outer pockets **34** of string of springs **26**. There are divides **64** along the tops and bottoms of the strings **26b**.

[0088] FIG. **7** illustrates a two-sided string **26b** for use in a double-sided pocketed spring assembly **12b**, as shown in FIG. **1B**. Two cushion pads **54** are located inside each outer pocket **34b** along with an inner pocketed spring **82b** located between the cushion pads **54**. One of the cushion pads **54** is located above the inner pocketed coil spring **82b** and the other cushion pad **54** is located below the inner pocketed coil spring **82b**. Although FIG. **7** illustrates cushion pads **54** lacking covers, encased cushion pads **51** or cushion pads of different shapes, such as shown in FIG. **2A**, may be used in the double-sided string **26b** or any string shown or described herein.

[0089] Two buckling members **55** are located inside each outer pocket **34b** along with two cushion pads **54** and an inner pocketed spring **82b** located between the cushion pads **54** and between the buckling members **55**. One of the buckling members **55** is located above one of the cushion pads **54** and above the inner pocketed coil spring **82b**. The other buckling member **55** is located below the other cushion pad **54** and the inner pocketed coil spring **82b**. Although FIG. **7** illustrates buckling members **55** lacking covers, encased buckling members or buckling members of different shapes, such as shown in FIG. **12A-12H**, or any combination thereof, may be used in the double-sided string **26b** or any string shown or described herein.

[0090] As shown in FIG. **7**, the coil springs **36b** of inner pocketed springs **82b** are different than the coil springs **36** of inner pocketed springs **82** shown in FIGS. **2** and **3**. Each coil spring **36b** comprises a central or longitudinal axis **A1**, an upper end turn **38b**, a lower end turn **40b** and a plurality of central convolutions **42b** between the end turns. FIGS. **1B** and **7** illustrate a barrel-shaped coil spring **36b** in which the diameter of the end turns **38b**, **40b** is less than the diameter of the central convolutions **42b**, the central convolutions **42b** tapering or decreasing in diameter and pitch as one moves from a center or middle portion **44b** of the coil spring towards the end turns. As best shown in FIG. **7**, each barrel-shaped coil spring **36b** has two identical end portions **46b**.

[0091] Referring now to FIG. **8**, longitudinally extending strings are shown in one preferable arrangement for a pocketed spring assembly for a bedding or seating product, such as a mattress. As can be seen, the longitudinally extending strings are arranged in a plurality of zones on the pocketed spring assembly **12d**. By way of example, two zones **72**, **74** are illustrated, with the zones corresponding roughly to a “firm” side and a “soft” side. By way of further example, the longitudinally extending strings of the “soft” zone **72** may have the split top feature shown and described herein. The longitudinally extending strings of the “firm” zone **74** may lack the split top feature. In another example, the strings of the “soft” zone **72** may have different buckling members or different cushion pads or both than the strings of the “firm” zone **74**, resulting in the different zones **72**, **74** having different feels or firmness. Of course, other arrangements are within the scope of the invention. For example, a pocketed spring assembly like pocketed spring assembly **12d** shown in FIG. **8** may comprise transversely extending strings rather than longitudinally extending

strings. In such an arrangement, each transversely extending string would have to be half firm and half soft. In one example, each string would have only half the string having the split top feature, the other half lacking such feature.

[0092] Referring now to FIG. 9, the transversely extending strings are shown in one preferable arrangement for a pocketed spring assembly 12e for a bedding or seating product, such as a mattress. As can be seen, the transversely extending strings are arranged in a plurality of zones on the pocketed spring assembly 12e. By way of example, three zones are illustrated, with the zones corresponding roughly to the location of a sleeper's head and shoulders, mid-section, knees and feet. By way of further example, the two end "soft" zones 86 each comprise strings of springs having the split top feature shown and described herein. The transversely extending strings of the middle or "firm" zone 88 are strings lacking any split top feature. Of course, other arrangements are within the scope of the invention. For example, the mattress shown in FIG. 9 may comprise longitudinally extending strings rather than transversely extending strings. In such an arrangement, each longitudinally extending string would have to be divided into three sections; a middle "firm" section and two end or "soft" sections. Therefore, each string would have only the end thirds of the string having the split top feature, the middle third lacking such feature.

[0093] FIGS. 3C and 3D illustrate portions of other embodiments of strings 26d, 26e, respectively, which may be incorporated into any of the products shown or described herein. The strings 26d, 26e each comprise the same seams and outer pockets 34 as incorporated into strings 26 shown in FIGS. 2 and 3. However, the springs 36d, 36e within the strings 26d, 26e, respectively are different than the springs 36 of strings 26. Although springs 36d, 36e are only shown in FIGS. 3C and 3D, they may be used in any string shown or described herein, including two-sided strings having cushion pads and buckling members above and below each inner pocketed coil spring regardless of the coil spring.

[0094] As shown in FIG. 3C, coil springs 36d (only one being shown) each have identical end turns 38d of a smaller diameter than the central convolutions 42d therebetween in a central portion 44d thereof. The central convolutions 42d of coil springs 36d are identical having the same diameter which is greater than the diameter of end turns 38d.

[0095] As shown in FIG. 3D, coil springs 36e (only one being shown) each have two identical end portions 46e and a central portion 44e therebetween. The central portion 44e has more convolutions than each end portion 46e, as shown in FIG. 3D. Each coil spring 36e has identical end turns 38e of a larger diameter than the central convolutions 42e therebetween of the central portion 44e. The central convolutions 42e of coil springs 36e have a smaller diameter than the diameter of end turns 38e.

[0096] FIG. 10 illustrates another embodiment of string 26d which may be used in any of the pocketed spring assemblies or products shown or described herein. The double-sided string 26d comprises the same seams, same coil springs 36b and outer fabric pockets 34b as incorporated into strings 26b shown in FIG. 7. However, each coil spring 36 lacks an inner pocket but has two individually pocketed combination pads 51.

[0097] Like the combination pads 51 shown in FIG. 6, each of the outer fabric pockets 34b includes a combination pad 51 above the coil spring 36b. However, in double-sided string 26d, a second combination pad 51 is located below the coil spring 36b. Each combination pad 51 comprises a cushion pad 54 and a buckling member 55 which in combination are encased in a fabric cover 84. Each combination pad 51 has its own fabric cover 84 which prevents un-pocketed coil spring 36b from contacting and damaging the cushion pad or pads over time.

[0098] Although string 26d is shown as a double-sided string, the concept illustrated therein of combining an un-pocketed coil spring with pocketed combination pads may be incorporated into any of the strings or pocketed spring assemblies shown or described herein, including single sided strings and single-sided pocketed spring assemblies. Any of the coil springs shown or described herein may be used in a version in which the cushion pad or pads/buckling member or buckling

members is pocketed and the coil spring has no inner pocket, just an outer pocket.

[0099] FIG. 11 illustrates another embodiment of string 26e which may be used in any of the pocketed spring assemblies or products shown or described herein. The double-sided string 26e comprises transverse seams 252, same inner pocketed springs 82b including same coil springs 36b as shown in FIG. 7, cushion pads 54 and cushion members 55. Each cushion pad 54 is encased in a fabric cover 84b and each buckling member 55 is encased in a fabric cover 84a. Thus, each cushion pad 54 has its own fabric cover 84b which prevents the coil spring 36 of the inner pocketed coil spring 82 from contacting and damaging the cushion pad or pads over time, in addition to the inner pocket 35 of fabric of the inner pocketed coil spring 82.

[0100] However, each string 26e lacks divides 64 or “split top” feature. Any of the embodiments of strings or pocketed spring assemblies shown or described herein may lack the divides or “split top” feature regardless of the whether one-sided or double-sided.

[0101] FIGS. 12A-12H illustrate top views of different buckling members which may be substituted for the buckling members 55 shown and described herein. Although each of the buckling members shown in FIGS. 12A-12H are illustrated being un-pocketed any of them may be individually pocketed.

[0102] FIG. 12A illustrates a cross-sectional view of another cylindrical shaped buckling member 55a which may be used in any embodiment of string shown or described herein. Buckling member 55a is illustrated having a circular outer wall 57a having an outer surface 59a and an inner surface 61a, the distance between which defines the thickness “Ta” of the circular outer wall 57a. The buckling member 55a has four internal ribs 63a which extend from the outer wall 57a to a center 65a. The buckling member 55a may be any desired height. The buckling member 55a has an open top and open bottom defining four internal passages 75a between the internal ribs 63a and outer wall 57a. Although the drawings illustrate one thickness “Ta” of outer wall 57a, the outer wall 57a may be any desired thickness. Although the drawings illustrate the internal ribs 63a having one thickness, the internal ribs may be any desired thickness.

[0103] FIG. 12B illustrates a cross-sectional view of another cylindrical shaped buckling member 55b which may be used in any embodiment of string shown or described herein. Buckling member 55b is illustrated having a circular outer wall 57b having an outer surface 59b and an inner surface 61b, the distance between which defines the thickness “Tb” of the circular outer wall 57b. The buckling member 55a has no internal ribs and may be any desired height. The buckling member 55b has an open top and open bottom defining one internal passage 75b inside outer wall 57b. Although the drawings illustrate one thickness “Tb” of outer wall 57b, the outer wall 57b may be any desired thickness.

[0104] FIG. 12C illustrates a cross-sectional view of another buckling member 55c which may be used in any embodiment of string shown or described herein. Buckling member 55c is illustrated having a triangular shaped outer wall 57c having an outer surface 59c and an inner surface 61c, the distance between which defines the thickness “Tc” of the triangular outer wall 57c. The buckling member 55c may be any desired height. The buckling member 55c has an open top and open bottom defining one internal passage 75c inside outer wall 57c. Although the drawings illustrate one thickness “Tc” of outer wall 57c, the outer wall 57c may be any desired thickness.

[0105] FIG. 12D illustrates a cross-sectional view of another buckling member 55d which may be used in any embodiment of string shown or described herein. Buckling member 55d is illustrated having a square shaped outer wall 57d having an outer surface 59d and an inner surface 61d, the distance between which defines the thickness “Td” of the square outer wall 57d. The buckling member 55d may be any desired height. The buckling member 55d has an open top and open bottom defining one internal passage 75d inside outer wall 57d. Although the drawings illustrate one thickness “Td” of outer wall 57d, the outer wall 57d may be any desired thickness.

[0106] FIG. 12E illustrates a cross-sectional view of another buckling member 55e which may be used in any embodiment of string shown or described herein. Buckling member 55e is illustrated

having a pentagon shaped outer wall **57e** having an outer surface **59e** and an inner surface **61e**, the distance between which defines the thickness “**Te**” of the pentagon outer wall **57e**. The buckling member **55e** may be any desired height. The buckling member **55e** has an open top and open bottom defining one internal passage **75e** inside outer wall **57e**. Although the drawings illustrate one thickness “**Te**” of outer wall **57e**, the outer wall **57e** may be any desired thickness.

[0107] FIG. **12F** illustrates a cross-sectional view of another buckling member **55f** which may be used in any embodiment of string shown or described herein. Buckling member **55f** is illustrated having a hexagon shaped outer wall **57f** having an outer surface **59f** and an inner surface **61f**, the distance between which defines the thickness “**Tf**” of the hexagon outer wall **57f**. The buckling member **55f** may be any desired height. The buckling member **55f** has an open top and open bottom defining one internal passage **75f** inside outer wall **57f**. Although the drawings illustrate one thickness “**Tf**” of outer wall **57f**, the outer wall **57f** may be any desired thickness.

[0108] FIG. **12G** illustrates a cross-sectional view of another buckling member **55g** which may be used in any embodiment of string shown or described herein. Buckling member **55g** is illustrated having a heptagon shaped outer wall **57g** having an outer surface **59g** and an inner surface **61g**, the distance between which defines the thickness “**Tg**” of the pentagon outer wall **57g**. The buckling member **55g** may be any desired height. The buckling member **55g** has an open top and open bottom defining one internal passage **75g** inside outer wall **57g**. Although the drawings illustrate one thickness “**Tg**” of outer wall **57g**, the outer wall **57g** may be any desired thickness.

[0109] FIG. **12H** illustrates a cross-sectional view of another buckling member **55h** which may be used in any embodiment of string shown or described herein. Buckling member **55h** is illustrated having an octagon shaped outer wall **57h** having an outer surface **59h** and an inner surface **61h**, the distance between which defines the thickness “**Th**” of the pentagon outer wall **57h**. The buckling member **55h** may be any desired height. The buckling member **55h** has an open top and open bottom defining one internal passage **75h** inside outer wall **57h**. Although the drawings illustrate one thickness “**Th**” of outer wall **57h**, the outer wall **57h** may be any desired thickness.

[0110] FIG. **13** is a schematic illustration of a cross-section of a single-sided string **90** for use in a single-sided pocketed spring assembly. The single-sided string **90** comprises an outer pocket **92** having a height **H1**. A main member **94** having a height **H3** is located inside the outer pocket **92** at the bottom thereof. A supplemental member **96** having a height **H2** is located above the main member **94** inside the outer pocket **92**. The sum of the heights **H3**, **H2** of the main and supplemental members **94**, **96**, respectively, is approximately the same as the height **H1** of the single-sided string **90**. The drawings are not intended to limit the heights of the main and supplemental members **94**, **96** to those illustrated. The main member **94** may be a pocketed spring, a non-pocketed spring, a pocketed or non-pocketed foam member or a pocketed or non-pocketed buckling member. The supplemental member **96** may be a pocketed spring, a non-pocketed spring, a pocketed or non-pocketed foam member or a pocketed or non-pocketed buckling member. Although FIG. **13** illustrates the main and supplemental members **94**, **96**, respectively, being cylindrical, either one of them may be any desired shape, including any of the shapes shown in FIG. **12A-12H**.

[0111] FIG. **14** is a schematic illustration of a cross-section of a single-sided string **98** for use in a single-sided pocketed spring assembly. The single-sided string **98** comprises an outer pocket **100** having a height **H4**. A main member **102** having a height **H5** is located inside the outer pocket **100** at the bottom thereof. A first supplemental member **104** having a height **H6** is located above the main member **102** inside the outer pocket **100**. A second supplemental member **106** having a height **H7** is located above the first supplemental member **104** inside the outer pocket **100**. The sum of the heights **H5**, **H6** and **H7** of the main and supplemental members **102**, **104**, **106**, respectively, is approximately the same as the height **H4** of the single-sided string **98**. The drawings are not intended to limit the heights of the main and supplemental members **102**, **104**, **106** to those illustrated. The main member **102** may be a pocketed spring, a non-pocketed spring, a pocketed or

non-pocketed foam member or a pocketed or non-pocketed buckling member. The first supplemental member **104** may be a pocketed spring, a non-pocketed spring, a pocketed or non-pocketed foam member or a pocketed or non-pocketed buckling member. The second supplemental member **106** may be a pocketed spring, a non-pocketed spring, a pocketed or non-pocketed foam member or a pocketed or non-pocketed buckling member. Although FIG. **14** illustrates the main and supplemental members **102**, **104**, **106**, respectively, being cylindrical, either one of them may be any desired shape, including any of the shapes shown in FIG. **12A-12H**.

[0112] FIG. **15** is a schematic illustration of a cross-section of a single-sided string **108** for use in a single-sided pocketed spring assembly. The single-sided string **108** comprises an outer pocket **110** having a height **H8**. A main member **112** having a height **H9** is located inside the outer pocket **110** at the bottom thereof. A first supplemental member **114** having a height **H10** is located above the main member **112** inside the outer pocket **110**. A second or middle supplemental member **116** having a height **H11** is located above the first supplemental member **114** inside the outer pocket **110**. A third supplemental member **118** having a height **H12** is located above the second or middle supplemental member **116** inside the outer pocket **110**. The sum of the heights **H9**, **H10**, **H11** and **H12** of the main and supplemental members **112**, **114**, **116**, **118** respectively, is approximately the same as the height **H8** of the single-sided string **108**. The drawings are not intended to limit the heights of the main and supplemental members **112**, **114**, **116**, **118** to those illustrated. The main member **112** may be a pocketed spring, a non-pocketed spring, a pocketed or non-pocketed foam member or a pocketed or non-pocketed buckling member. The first supplemental member **114** may be a pocketed spring, a non-pocketed spring, a pocketed or non-pocketed foam member or a pocketed or non-pocketed buckling member. The second supplemental member **116** may be a pocketed spring, a non-pocketed spring, a pocketed or non-pocketed foam member or a pocketed or non-pocketed buckling member. The third supplemental member **118** may be a pocketed spring, a non-pocketed spring, a pocketed or non-pocketed foam member or a pocketed or non-pocketed buckling member. Although FIG. **15** illustrates the main and supplemental members **112**, **114**, **116**, **118** respectively, being cylindrical, any one of them may be any desired shape, including any of the shapes shown in FIG. **12A-12H**.

[0113] FIG. **16** is a schematic illustration of a double-sided string **290** for use in a double-sided pocketed spring assembly. The double-sided string **290** comprises a main member **294** and two supplemental members **296** encased by an outer pocket **292**. As shown in FIG. **16**, the double-sided string **290** in a relaxed condition has a height **HH1**. The main member **294** has a height **HH3** and is located inside the outer pocket **292** between the two supplemental members **296**. Each supplemental member **296** inside the outer pocket **292** has a height **HH2**. The sum of the heights **HH3**, **HH2** of the main and supplemental members **294**, **296** is approximately the same as the height **HH1** of the double-sided string **290** when the double-sided string **290** is in a relaxed condition as shown in FIG. **16**. The drawings are not intended to limit the heights of the main and supplemental members **294**, **296** to those illustrated. The main member **294** may be a pocketed spring, a non-pocketed spring, a pocketed or non-pocketed foam member or a pocketed or non-pocketed buckling member. Each supplemental member **296** may be a pocketed spring, a non-pocketed spring, a pocketed or non-pocketed foam member or a pocketed or non-pocketed buckling member. Although FIG. **16** illustrates the main and supplemental members **294**, **296** being cylindrical, any of them may be any desired shape, including any of the shapes shown in FIG. **12A-12H**.

[0114] FIG. **17** is a schematic illustration of a cross-section of a double-sided string **298** for use in a double-sided pocketed spring assembly. The double-sided string **298** comprises a main member **202**, two inner supplemental members **204** and two outer supplemental members **206**. The main member **202**, two inner supplemental members **204** and two outer supplemental members **206** are encased by an outer pocket **200**. As shown in FIG. **17**, the double-sided string **298** in a relaxed condition has a height **HH4**. The main member **202** has a height **HH5** and is located between the

two inner supplemental members **204** inside the outer pocket **200**. Each inner supplemental member **204** has a height HH6. An upper or first inner supplemental member **204** is located above the main member **202** inside the outer pocket **200**. A lower or second inner supplemental member **204** is located below the main member **202** inside the outer pocket **200**. An upper outer supplemental member **206** having a height HH7 is located above the upper inner supplemental member **204** inside the outer pocket **200**. A second or lower outer supplemental member **206** having a height HH7 is located below the lower inner supplemental member **204** inside the outer pocket **200**. The sum of the heights HH5, HH6 and HH7 of the main and supplemental members **202**, **204**, **206**, respectively, is approximately the same as the height HH4 of the double-sided string **298** when the double-sided string **298** is in a relaxed condition. The drawings are not intended to limit the heights of the main and supplemental members **202**, **204**, **206** to those illustrated. The main member **202** may be a pocketed spring, a non-pocketed spring, a pocketed or non-pocketed foam member or a pocketed or non-pocketed buckling member. Each inner supplemental member **204** may be a pocketed spring, a non-pocketed spring, a pocketed or non-pocketed foam member or a pocketed or non-pocketed buckling member. Each outer supplemental member **206** may be a pocketed spring, a non-pocketed spring, a pocketed or non-pocketed foam member or a pocketed or non-pocketed buckling member. Although FIG. 17 illustrates the main and supplemental members **202**, **204**, **206**, respectively, being cylindrical, either one of them may be any desired shape, including any of the shapes shown in FIG. 12A-12H.

[0115] FIG. 18 is a schematic illustration of a cross-section of a double-sided string **208** for use in a double-sided pocketed spring assembly. The double-sided string **208** comprises an outer pocket **210**, two inner supplemental members **214**, two middle supplemental members **216** and two outer supplemental members **218**. The main member **212**, two inner supplemental members **214**, two middle supplemental members **216** and two outer supplemental members **218** are encased by an outer pocket **110**. As shown in FIG. 18, the double-sided string **208** in a relaxed condition has a height HH8. The main member **212** has a height HH9 and is located between the two inner supplemental members **214** inside the outer pocket **210**. Each inner supplemental member **214** has a height HH10. An upper or first inner supplemental member **214** is located above the main member **212** inside the outer pocket **208**. A lower or second inner supplemental member **214** is located below the main member **212** inside the outer pocket **210**. An upper middle supplemental member **216** having a height HH11 is located above the upper inner supplemental member **214** inside the outer pocket **210**. A second or lower middle supplemental member **216** having a height HH11 is located below the lower inner supplemental member **214** inside the outer pocket **210**. An upper outer supplemental member **218** having a height HH12 is located above the upper middle supplemental member **216** inside the outer pocket **210**. A second or lower outer supplemental member **218** having a height HH12 is located below the middle supplemental member **216** inside the outer pocket **210**. The sum of the heights HH9, HH10, HH11 and HH12 of the main and supplemental members **212**, **214**, **216**, **218**, respectively, is approximately the same as the height HH8 of the double-sided string **208** when the double-sided string **208** is in a relaxed condition. The drawings are not intended to limit the heights of the main and supplemental members **212**, **214**, **216**, **218** to those illustrated. The main member **212** may be a pocketed spring, a non-pocketed spring, a pocketed or non-pocketed foam member or a pocketed or non-pocketed buckling member. Each inner supplemental member **214** may be a pocketed spring, a non-pocketed spring, a pocketed or non-pocketed foam member or a pocketed or non-pocketed buckling member. Each middle supplemental member **216** may be a pocketed spring, a non-pocketed spring, a pocketed or non-pocketed foam member or a pocketed or non-pocketed buckling member. Each outer supplemental member **218** may be a pocketed spring, a non-pocketed spring, a pocketed or non-pocketed foam member or a pocketed or non-pocketed buckling member. Although FIG. 18 illustrates the main and supplemental members **212**, **214**, **216**, **218**, respectively, being cylindrical, either one of them may be any desired shape, including any of the shapes shown in FIG. 12A-12H.

[0116] As shown in FIGS. 13-18, whether a string is single-sided or double-sided, without its fabric outer cover, any number of combinations of springs, foam and buckling members are possible. Any one or more of the springs, foam and buckling members may be encased in its own fabric cover. Any one or more of the springs, foam and buckling members may be any desired shape.

[0117] The various embodiments of the invention shown and described are merely for illustrative purposes only, as the drawings and the description are not intended to restrict or limit in any way the scope of the claims. Those skilled in the art will appreciate various changes, modifications, and improvements which can be made to the invention without departing from the spirit or scope thereof. The invention in its broader aspects is therefore not limited to the specific details and representative apparatus and methods shown and described. Departures may therefore be made from such details without departing from the spirit or scope of the general inventive concept. For example, more than two cushion pads or more than one inner pocketed spring may be inside an outer pocket. The invention resides in each individual feature described herein, alone, and in all combinations of any and all of those features. Accordingly, the scope of the invention shall be limited only by the following claims and their equivalents.

Claims

1. A bedding or seating product comprising: a pocketed spring assembly comprising a plurality of parallel strings of springs, each of said strings being joined to at least one adjacent string, each of said strings comprising a piece of fabric surrounding a plurality of inner pocketed springs, a plurality of cushion pads and a plurality of buckling members, first and second opposed plies of fabric being on opposite sides of the inner pocketed springs, cushion pads and buckling members, a plurality of outer pockets formed along said string by a longitudinal seam and transverse seams joining said first and second plies, at least one inner pocketed spring and at least one cushion pad and at least one buckling member being in each of said outer pockets, wherein at least some of the buckling members contain phase change materials.
2. The product of claim 1, wherein each of the buckling members is made of rubber.
3. The product of claim 1, wherein each of the cushion pads is individually pocketed.
4. The product of claim 1, wherein an upper end of each of said transverse seams is below an upper surface of the string to partially separate adjacent outer pockets.
5. The product of claim 1, wherein one of the cushion pads and one of the buckling members are pocketed together inside one of the outer pockets.
6. The product of claim 1, wherein two cushion pads and two buckling members are in each of the outer pockets.
7. The product of claim 1, wherein at least one cushion pad and at least one buckling member are above one of the inner pocketed springs inside each of the outer pockets.
8. A pocketed spring assembly for a bedding or seating product, said pocketed spring assembly comprising: a plurality of parallel strings of springs, each of the strings being joined to at least one adjacent string, each of the strings comprising a plurality of interconnected outer pockets made from one piece of fabric, each of the outer pockets containing an inner pocketed spring and a combination pad, the combination pad comprising a cushion pad and a buckling member encased together in a fabric cover, the piece of fabric being joined to itself along a longitudinal seam and having first and second opposed plies of fabric on opposite sides of the springs, the first and second plies being joined by transverse seams between adjacent inner pocketed springs, wherein the buckling member has an outer wall, internal ribs extending inwardly from the outer wall to a center, an open top and an open bottom defining passages between the internal ribs and further wherein the buckling member contains phase change materials.
9. The pocketed spring assembly of claim 8, wherein two cushion pads and two buckling members are in each of the outer pockets.

- 10.** The pocketed spring assembly of claim 9, wherein said inner pocketed spring is between the cushion pads and between the buckling members in each of the outer pockets.
 - 11.** The pocketed spring assembly of claim 8, wherein each of said transverse seams forming adjacent outer pockets of said string has one end located below an upper surface of said string to partially separate adjacent outer pockets.
 - 12.** The pocketed spring assembly of claim 11, wherein the inner pocketed springs are below the upper end of adjacent transverse seams.
 - 13.** The pocketed spring assembly of claim 8, wherein each of said cushion pads is made at least partially of foam.
 - 14.** The pocketed spring assembly of claim 8, wherein the buckling member has four internal ribs.
 - 15.** A pocketed spring assembly for a bedding or seating product, said pocketed spring assembly comprising: a plurality of parallel strings of springs, each of the strings being joined to an adjacent string, each of the strings comprising a plurality of interconnected outer pockets made from one piece of fabric, each of the outer pockets containing one inner pocketed spring, and a combination pad comprising at least one cushion pad and at least one buckling member, the piece of fabric being joined to itself along a longitudinal seam and having first and second opposed plies of fabric on opposite sides of the inner pocketed springs, the fabric of said first and second plies being joined by transverse seams, each of the transverse seams being shorter than the string, wherein each of the buckling members has an outer wall, internal ribs extending inwardly from the outer wall to a center, an open top and an open bottom defining passages between the internal ribs and further wherein the buckling member contains phase change materials.
 - 16.** The pocketed spring assembly of claim 15, wherein each of the buckling members has four internal ribs.
 - 17.** The pocketed spring assembly of claim 15, wherein said buckling members are made of plastic.
 - 18.** The pocketed spring assembly of claim 15, wherein each of said buckling members is individually pocketed with at least one of the cushion pads.
 - 19.** The pocketed spring assembly of claim 15, wherein the cushion pads are made at least partially of foam.
 - 20.** The pocketed spring assembly of claim 15, wherein at least one of the buckling members has a hollow interior.
-